

# How to Improve Forecasting and Delivery

A Comprehensive Training on N and T Parameters



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INTEGRATED BUSINESS PLANNING

PLANNING MODULES

DATA INPUT

DATA REVIEW

MODELING

Dynamic Forecasting

Regular Recalibration

PLANNING

SIMULATION

REPORTING

PLANNING MODULES

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## AGENDA

# Training Overview

01

### Key Points Identification & Analysis

Understanding the core challenges in forecasting and delivery processes

02

### How to Input Accurate N and T

Mastering product list accuracy and time parameter management

03

### Sales Forecasting Process

Order commitments and delivery planning in forecasting workflows

04

### Project & Supply Chain Coordination

Collaboration between approved projects, general projects, and supply chain



### Training Objective

Enhance forecasting accuracy and delivery efficiency through systematic training on N and T parameters



### Target Audience

Sales teams, pre-sales engineers, and supply chain professionals involved in forecasting processes

# Four Core Points for Forecasting & Delivery

1

## Accuracy of N and T Parameters

Accurate N (product list) and T (time parameters) directly impact three critical business functions: **sales forecasting**, **supply chain preparation**, and **order delivery processes**. Inaccurate inputs create cascading failures across the entire fulfillment cycle.

2

## Beyond Order Commitment

To better support backend preparation and delivery, sales forecasting must manage not only **order commitments** but also **delivery timing requirements**. Both dimensions are essential for synchronized operations.

3

## Supply Chain Support

Supply chain support for front-end sales projects plays a **crucial role** in both preparation and delivery. Early engagement and collaboration ensure that forecasted demands align with operational capabilities and inventory strategies.

4

## Channel Communication

Forecasted order and delivery timing must be **promptly communicated and confirmed** with channels. This ensures that front-end commitments remain synchronized with back-end execution, preventing costly mismatches.



**Key Insight:** These four points are interdependent. Success requires coordinated effort across sales, pre-sales, supply chain, and channel partners.

# Understanding N: Definition & Key Factors



## What is N?

**N represents the Product List** — the definitive expression of customer requirements. Making N accurate means ensuring the product list is precise and aligned with actual needs.

- ✓ **Condition 1: Accurate Configuration**  
Product list must be accurately configured to match customer needs, following **PMF strategy**
- ✓ **Condition 2: Timely CRM Updates**  
Product list must be promptly updated in the CRM system for system-wide visibility

## Two Business Scenarios

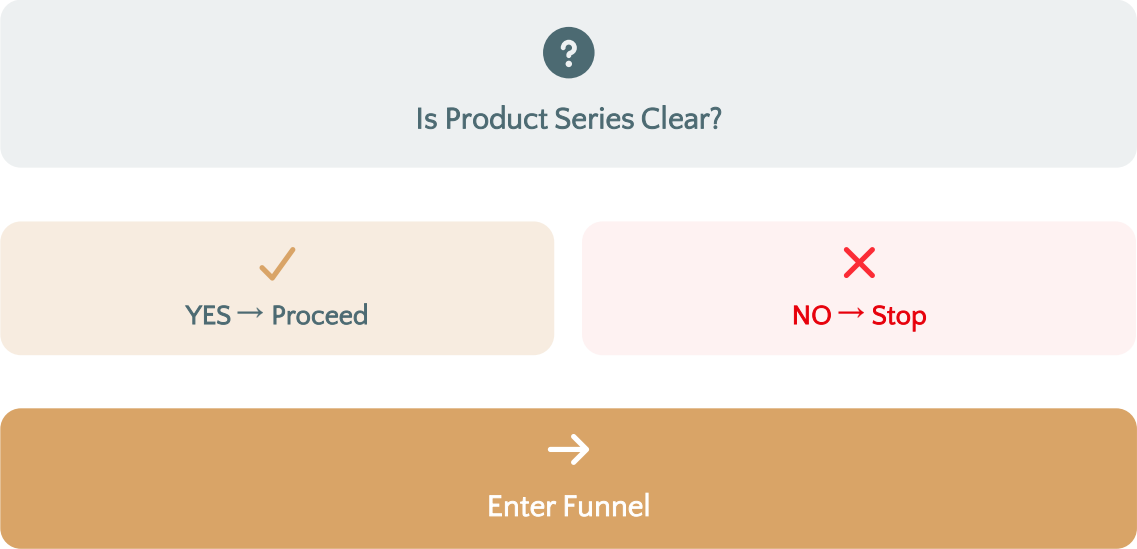
### 1. Entering Funnel

When project moves from outside to inside funnel, **product series must be clearly defined**; otherwise, funnel entry is not permitted

### 2. Funnel Management

For funnel projects, **forecast category** and **days to bid opening** determine credibility requirements. Lists below threshold must be improved within specified timeframe

## Funnel Entry Decision Flow



## Key Benefits

- Improves overall funnel quality
- Strengthens product sales forecasting
- Accurately reflects market demand

## Ownership

Primary: Pre-sales

Support: Sales (CRM updates)

# N Credibility: Four Standards & Two Business Types

## Two Business Processes

### Process 1: Funnel Entry

Projects moving from outside to inside funnel

### Process 2: Funnel Management

Ongoing management of existing funnel projects

## Framework Benefits

- ✓ Standardized evaluation criteria
- ✓ Objective quality measurement
- ✓ Proactive issue identification

1

### Self-Assessment Scoring

Pre-sales evaluates product lists using weighted criteria across four dimensions

Used in: Both processes

2

### Funnel Entry Criteria

Minimum requirements for projects entering the funnel: Budget  $\geq 3$  AND Product Series  $\geq 3$

Used in: Process 1 only

3

### Forecast Category Thresholds

Different credibility requirements based on prediction category: Possible- (24%), Possible+ (60%), Advantaged (80%)

Used in: Process 2

4

### Bid Timeline Requirements

Within 30 days of bid opening: Non-weak current/ICT (100%), Weak current/ICT (65%)

Used in: Process 2

**Implementation Note:** These four standards work together to ensure product list quality throughout the project lifecycle, from initial entry to ongoing management.

# Self-Assessment Scoring Criteria

| Category             | Weight | Score | Result | Scoring Criteria (5-Point System)                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------|-------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project Budget       | 20%    | 3     | 0.6    | 5: Confirmed budget & pricing strategy<br>4: Clear budget<br>3: Estimable budget                                                           |
| Technical Route      | 20%    | 3     | 0.6    | 5: All series confirmable (in tender doc)<br>4: 80%+ series confirmable (decision made)<br>3: 50%+ series confirmable (our recommendation) |
| Product Model        | 30%    | 3     | 0.9    | 5: All models confirmable (specs in tender)<br>4: 80%+ models confirmable<br>3: 50%+ models confirmable                                    |
| Performance/Quantity | 30%    | 3     | 0.9    | 5: All quantities confirmed (in tender)<br>4: 80%+ quantities confirmed<br>3: 50%+ quantities confirmed                                    |

## Total Credibility Score

60%

Minimum for funnel entry

## Scoring System

- 5: Fully confirmed
- 4: 80%+ certain
- 3: 50%+ certain
- 0: Below 50%

## Key Notes

- Product series defined by configurator
- Sales judgment for budget
- Technical specs in tender docs = highest certainty

# Funnel Entry & Forecast Thresholds

## 2 Standard 2: Funnel Entry Criteria

When entering the funnel, pre-sales conducts self-assessment. The product list can only be shared with sales when **both "Budget Amount" and "Product Series" score  $\geq 3$  points**. Sales can then import the shared list (which carries the credibility score) and submit the funnel application.

$\geq 3$

Budget Amount

$\geq 3$

Product Series

## 3 Standard 3: Forecast Category Thresholds

Different forecast categories require different levels of credibility:

Possible- 24%

Possible+ 60%

Advantaged 80%

## 4 Standard 4: Bid Timeline Requirements

When bid opening is within **30 days**, credibility requirements vary by project type:

Non-Weak Current & ICT 100%  
Full certainty required due to tight timeline

Lower threshold accounting for project complexity  
Weak Current & EPC 65%

# Understanding 3T: Critical Time Parameters

 **T1**

**Required Delivery Time**

The time when customer requires goods on site (not just our company, but for the entire project). Calculated by working backward from go-live date.

Applies to: All projects

 **T2**

**Estimated Order Date**

Calculated as: Required Delivery Time minus SLA (order processing lead time in ERP system)

Applies to: All projects

 **T3**

**Estimated Bid Date**

Varies by project type (see details in next section)

Applies to: Specific project types

| Estimated Bid Date (T3) by Project Type                                                                 |                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Government/Standard Procurement</b><br>Date of bid announcement or notification (not bidding date)   | <b>Weak Current &amp; EPC</b><br>Contract signing date with us or our agent |
| <b>ICT &amp; Investment/Financing</b><br>Contract signing with investor or designated financing channel | <b>Framework OC Sub-projects</b><br>PO (Purchase Order) generation time     |

**Key Principle**

T1 drives T2: Required Delivery Time (T1) minus SLA determines Estimated Order Date (T2). Accurate T1 is critical for the entire timeline.

**Critical Note**

"Required Delivery Time" is no longer strongly tied to "Stock-up or Not" — it's for planning, not commitment.



# Required Delivery Time: Estimation Methods

## Two Estimation Scenarios

### 1 Scenario 1: No Extensive Cabling

For projects **not requiring extensive cabling work**, calculate backward from go-live date:

Go-Live Date – 15 Days

### 2 Scenario 2: Extensive Cabling

For projects **involving extensive cabling work**, allow longer lead time:

Go-Live Date – 30 Days

## Critical Success Factor

Sales must proactively communicate with customers/channels to confirm final go-live time and construction cycle, updating "Required Delivery Time" in CRM promptly.

## Filling Examples

### Example 1: No Extensive Cabling

"Confirmed with client's IT Director: project go-live Sep 30. No extensive cabling. 15-day lead time gives **Sep 15 Required Delivery Time**, confirmed feasible."

### Example 2: Extensive Cabling

"Confirmed with PM: go-live Sep 30. Extensive cabling needed. 30-day lead time gives **Sep 1 Required Delivery Time**, confirmed feasible."

### Example 3: Urgent/Flow Projects

Fill based on actual situation. Maintain close communication with supply chain for coordination.

## Important Note

Sales must fill "Required Delivery Time" AND explain basis in "Stock-up Notes" field; otherwise, the date cannot be submitted.

# Estimated Order & Bid Time: Methods

## T2: Estimated Order Date Calculation

For all projects, Estimated Order Date = Required Delivery Time (T1) – SLA

### Multi-Product Orders

If products have different SLAs, use the **maximum SLA value**

### Example

Products A (3d), B (7d), C (14d) → Order SLA = **14 days**

### Quality Check

Entered date must be  $\geq$  SLA-calculated date

## T3: Forward Method

**Formula:** Current Time + Customer Procurement Cycles

### Application Steps

1. Identify current project stage
2. Map customer procurement process steps
3. Estimate duration for each step
4. Sum all procurement cycle times
5. Add to current date for estimated bid date

Best for: Early-stage projects

## T3: Backward Method

**Formula:** Customer Required Delivery – Key Activity Durations

### Deduction Items

- Contract signing and order processing cycle
- Project complexity buffer time
- Customer internal approval periods
- Buffer for potential delays

Best for: Projects with fixed delivery dates



**Guidance:** Use Forward Method as primary, Backward Method as validation. Combining both improves accuracy.

# Business Processes: Funnel Entry & Management

## 1 Process 1: Funnel Entry

### Step 1: Configure List

**Role:** Pre-sales | Configures product list, completes credibility self-assessment, shares if 达标

### Step 2: Import List

**Role:** Sales | Imports latest shared list (auto-verified), saves to CRM

### Step 3: Submit Application

**Role:** Sales | CRM auto-checks credibility; blocks if below threshold

### Step 4: Approve Funnel

**Role:** Regional Manager | Reviews application and credibility score

### Step 5: Calibrate List

**Role:** Pre-sales | Verifies consistency across systems

## 2 Process 2: Funnel Management

### Daily Self-Check

Regular monitoring of product list credibility

If not meet standard: Daily email alerts; **30-day window** to improve

### Upgrade Forecast Category

When upgrading (e.g., Possible+ to Advantaged)

System checks credibility; **30-day compliance**

### Update Bid Timeline

When bid opening date changes

System checks against Standard 4; **7-day compliance**

### Common Follow-up Actions

- Pre-sales updates and shares list
- Sales updates CRM system
- Pre-sales calibrates for accuracy

### Process 1 Key Control

System-enforced credibility check

### Process 2 Key Control

Automated alerts & time-bound compliance

### Success Factor

Collaboration & system enforcement

# Key Takeaways & Next Steps

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## 1 Accuracy is Foundation

Accurate N and T input is the **cornerstone** of supply chain efficiency. Quality inputs drive quality outputs.

## 2 Credibility Ensures Quality

The **four-standard credibility framework** ensures forecast quality and enables continuous improvement.

## 3 Communication is Essential

Proactive communication with **channels and customers** prevents mismatches and ensures alignment.

## 4 Continuous Monitoring

Regular updates and calibration maintain **forecast accuracy** throughout the project lifecycle.

## Call to Action

Implement these practices in your daily work. Collaborate closely with Sales, Pre-sales, and Supply Chain teams. Leverage the credibility framework and automated alerts to maintain high forecast quality and drive operational excellence.